19.8 Falls in Older Adults at Home

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I fell twice this year in the bathroom." **Objective** • 78 years old • Walks slowly, holds on to furniture • Home poorly lit	**ACTUAL** **Impaired walking** related to muscle weakness and poor balance as evidenced by slow, unsteady gait.	Within 2 weeks, walks safely with an aid.	• Check her gait, her balance and her home. • Give her a walking aid and show her how to use it. • Encourage balance and strength exercises. • Go through any medicines that make her dizzy with the doctor.	Walking safely: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I did not know my slippers were dangerous." **Objective** • Slippers loose • Rugs on the floor	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to home fall hazards as evidenced by unsafe footwear and rugs.	Can describe how to make her home safer.	• Teach the need for footwear that fits well. • Take up rugs; put in grab bars and night lights. • Check the home again at the next visit.	Describes the measures: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Has fallen before • Elderly	**RISK** **Risk for adult falls** as evidenced by risk factors: history of falls, older age and home hazards.	No more falls.	• Teach her how to get up after a fall and how to call for help. • Book follow-up visits. • Suggest a personal alarm.	No falls: **goal met**.